

# Kit vs. Top Email Tool Competitors (2026)

*A quick-reference comparison for bloggers choosing an email marketing tool.*

|                                       | Kit (formerly ConvertKit)                                                      | Mailchimp                                                                  | MailerLite                                                                   | ActiveCampaign                                                                                                |
|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Starting price                        | Free, then \$33/mo (Creator, 1,000 subs)                                       | ~\$13/mo (Essentials, discounted first 12 months)                          | \$12/mo (Comfort plan)                                                       | ~\$19/mo (Starter, 1,000 contacts)                                                                            |
| Free plan                             | Yes — up to 10,000 subscribers. Unlimited landing pages, forms & broadcasts.   | Yes — 250 contacts, 500 sends/mo, 1 audience.                              | Yes — 250 subscribers, 2,500 emails/mo.                                      | No — 14-day free trial only.                                                                                  |
| Automation / sequences                | Paid-plan only, then unlimited visual automations + unlimited email sequences. | None on Free. Essentials: up to 4 steps. Standard+: up to 200 flows.       | Free: 3 basic automations. Comfort: 50. Power: unlimited, 100 steps.         | Most powerful engine of the four — 950+ recipes, CRM-grade branching. Starter capped at 5 actions/automation. |
| Ease of setup (non-technical blogger) | Built for creators — simplest, most beginner-friendly of the four.             | Familiar, well-documented, but interface has grown more complex over time. | Simple drag-and-drop; consistently rated among the easiest to learn.         | Steepest learning curve of the four — powerful, but more to configure.                                        |
| Support quality                       | 24/7 email & chat on paid plans; free migration assistance.                    | Email/chat on paid tiers; phone + priority only on \$350/mo Premium tier.  | Email/community on Free & Comfort; 24/7 live chat starts at Power (\$25/mo). | Live chat & email on every tier; free guided onboarding; dedicated team on Pro/Enterprise.                    |

## Bottom line for bloggers

- **Just starting out, want the most free runway?** Kit's free plan (10,000 subscribers) beats Mailchimp and MailerLite's 250-subscriber caps by a wide margin — though automated sequences require a paid plan.
- **Want the cheapest paid automation?** MailerLite's Comfort plan (\$12/mo) is the lowest-cost entry into real automation.
- **Want the deepest automation and don't mind a learning curve?** ActiveCampaign has the most advanced automation builder, but no free tier and more setup complexity.
- **Want automation + simplicity without a big learning curve?** Kit is built for exactly this — content creators and bloggers, not general e-commerce or enterprise marketing teams.

*Pricing and plan details reflect each provider's published pricing pages as of September 2026 and are subject to change — always confirm current terms on the provider's site before signing up.*

*Sources: [kit.com/pricing](https://kit.com/pricing) · [mailchimp.com/pricing/marketing](https://mailchimp.com/pricing/marketing) · [mailerlite.com/pricing](https://mailerlite.com/pricing) · [activecampaign.com/pricing](https://activecampaign.com/pricing) (contact-tier pricing cross-checked via [emailtooltester.com](https://emailtooltester.com) and [emailvendorselection.com](https://emailvendorselection.com)).*